CREDITBUDDY PARTNERS PRIVATE LIMITED

CIN: U62090OR2026PTC[●●●●●●] | Registered: Bhubaneswar, Odisha

SAFETY & SECURITY POLICY

Platform Security, Data Protection & User Safety Framework

Version 1.0 | Effective: April 1, 2026

COMMITMENT TO SECURITY

CreditBuddy takes the security of your personal and financial data seriously. This Safety & Security Policy outlines the technical, organisational, and procedural measures we have implemented to protect your data, ensure platform integrity, and safeguard your experience across BORROW, LEARN, and EARN verticals.

1. Technical Security Architecture

1.1 Data Encryption

- All data transmitted between your device and CreditBuddy servers is encrypted using TLS 1.2 or higher.
- Sensitive data stored on CreditBuddy servers (including financial data, KYC documents, and identity information) is encrypted at rest using AES-256 encryption.
- Database-level encryption ensures data is unreadable even in the event of server-level compromise.

1.2 Authentication & Access Controls

- Multi-factor authentication (MFA): OTP-based verification for all login, critical transactions, and KYC submissions.
- Biometric authentication supported (fingerprint, face ID) as a secondary factor.
- Session management: Automatic session timeout after 10 minutes of inactivity on web; configurable on mobile.

- Internal access controls: CreditBuddy employees access user data only to the extent required for their specific role (least-privilege principle). Access logs are maintained.

1.3 Infrastructure Security

- Cloud infrastructure hosted on India-based servers with tier-3 or equivalent data centre certification.
- Web Application Firewall (WAF) deployed to block common attack vectors (SQL injection, XSS, CSRF).
- DDoS protection measures in place to ensure platform availability.
- Regular security patching and vulnerability management processes.

2. Application Security

- Periodic penetration testing conducted by qualified independent security professionals.
- Secure Software Development Lifecycle (SSDLC): Security reviews are integrated into development and deployment processes.
- Third-party security libraries are maintained up-to-date; dependency vulnerability scanning is automated.
- Mobile application security: Binary hardening, jailbreak/root detection, and certificate pinning to prevent man-in-the-middle attacks.
- API security: All APIs authenticated via tokens; rate limiting to prevent abuse; input validation to prevent injection attacks.

3. KYC & Financial Data Security

- Aadhaar data is handled exclusively through UIDAI-authorised channels. CreditBuddy does not store the full Aadhaar number; only the last 4 digits are displayed for reference.
- PAN data is tokenised after initial verification to reduce exposure.
- Bank account numbers are masked in all platform displays (showing only last 4 digits).
- Credit bureau queries are made only with your explicit consent on a per-application basis.
- Financial documents (bank statements, salary slips) are transmitted encrypted directly to the NBFC/Bank Partner and are not retained on CreditBuddy servers beyond the processing period.

4. Vendor & Partner Security

CreditBuddy requires all technology vendors and partner institutions to meet security standards before integration:

- Contractual data security obligations imposed on all vendors under data processing agreements.
- Vendor security assessments conducted before onboarding; periodic reassessments annually.
- NBFC and bank partners are separately regulated by RBI and are independently required to meet RBI's cybersecurity framework.
- EdTech and employer partners are required to comply with applicable data protection laws and maintain reasonable security standards as specified in integration agreements.

5. User Safety Guidelines

> **IMPORTANT — Phishing & Fraud Warning**
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> CreditBuddy will NEVER ask for your full Aadhaar number, password, OTP, or full credit card details via phone, email, or SMS. If you receive such a request claiming to be from CreditBuddy, it is fraudulent. Report it immediately to grievance@creditbuddy.in and to cybercrime.gov.in.

To keep your account safe:

- Never share your OTP, PIN, or password with anyone — including CreditBuddy support staff.
- Always verify that you are using the official CreditBuddy app (available on Google Play Store and Apple App Store) or the official website before entering any credentials.
- Enable biometric authentication and lock-screen security on your device.
- Log out from the Platform when using a shared device.
- Regularly review your account activity and report any unrecognised activity immediately.
- Ensure your registered mobile number is active and secure — your OTP is delivered to this number.

6. Incident Response

In the event of a security incident affecting your data:

1. CreditBuddy's security team initiates an immediate investigation upon detection of a breach or suspicious activity.
2. Affected users are notified within 72 hours of confirmed breach discovery.
3. Notification includes: nature of the incident, data potentially compromised, steps taken by CreditBuddy, and actions you should take to protect yourself.
4. Regulatory notifications are made to the Data Protection Board (once constituted) and to applicable regulators within prescribed timelines.
5. A post-incident review is conducted to prevent recurrence.

7. Business Continuity

- CreditBuddy maintains a Business Continuity Plan (BCP) to ensure platform availability during disasters, infrastructure failures, or other disruptions.
- Regular BCP tests are conducted to validate recovery time and recovery point objectives.
- Critical data is backed up in geographically separated India-based locations.
- Scheduled maintenance windows are communicated to users at least 24 hours in advance via in-app notification.

8. Reporting a Security Concern

Security Incident / Fraud	grievance@creditbuddy.in — Subject: Security Incident
National Cybercrime Portal	cybercrime.gov.in | Helpline: 1930
RBI Ombudsman (Loan-related fraud)	cms.rbi.org.in
CERT-In (Cybersecurity India)	https://www.cert-in.org.in/